YES WE HACK

POLE TO POLE

4 Ways a Bug Bounty Platform Delivers Fast, Complete ROI

The Covid pandemic has delivered a sharp shock to business security strategies. Faced with dramatic swings in revenue and profitability, **business leaders** are seeking out innovative new ways to drive security efficiency without impacting the company's return-to-growth.

As a CISO, you're caught in the crossfire. Your challenge is to safeguard security at lower cost: protecting data across more channels, more data, and an ever-evolving **cybersecurity landscape** – using security solutions that show a quantified return on investment (ROI).

Until now, penetration testing (pentesting) has been the default mechanism for finding security vulnerabilities that an attacker could exploit. However, as we saw in the previous article, pentesting lacks the 'digital dexterity' demanded by **the modern business**. Consultants often lack the relevant skills, for example, while tests are timed, one-off events, that absorb precious resources. That makes calculating **ROI extremely difficult**.

Forward-thinking CISOs are turning to **bug bounty platforms** to efficiently meet the challenges of cybersecurity. With bug bounty, you choose the experts in charge of your security and submit your scopes to be tested to the hunters you select – or to the entire community. It's simple, **agile**, **accountable**, and **innovative**.

Crucially, compared with pentesting, bug bounty also offers a dramatically fast, complete, and measurable return on your security investment.

Here's how. →



1. Pay only on results

ROI is tricky to quantify on a pentest. You pay a **fixed price** in advance, regardless of results. There's no guarantee of the quality of work, the number of issues reported, the time spent by the consultants, or the **mobilized skills**. A leading trust service provider recently commented: *"We have to pay even if nothing is found. Our last pentest cost around €8,000 and no major vulnerabilities were reported."*

By contrast, **bug bounty** is intrinsically results-oriented: you only pay for vulnerabilities that qualify based on your program rules. A leading APAC bank, for example, found that **the cost** per vulnerability using pentesting was €1,500 but only €400 using bug bounty. Another European financial institution reports, *"I have twice as many vulnerabilities reported via my bug bounty program than I did with pentesting, and it costs me about 50% less."*

2. Optimize audit costs

With a **bug bounty platform**, your budget is used to find and fix vulnerabilities based on your unique security program rules. There's one interface and a simple process for surfacing and managing vulnerabilities. Audit costs are reduced because you're not paying multiple audit providers, each requiring dedicated **project management**, to surface potentially irrelevant information. And you're not immersed in service kick-offs, presentation meetings, and other events.

The trust service provider reports, *"After two months running our program, dozens of security flaws had been reported...for a reward budget totalling around half of the cost of a single audit."*



3. Transparency and accountability

As we have seen, with a bug bounty program you only pay for each **bug that is reported and fixed**. Costs and transparent and accountable. You can measure the specific contribution of your audit budget to risk reduction – and in turn measure your audit **performance/ROI**.

Bug bounty can also help drive smarter, faster return on procurement costs. You can use it, for example, to identify vulnerabilities in third-party software that you are intending to purchase and deploy. **Armed with these insights**, you can blacklist flawed vendors, proactively preventing security breaches and additional costs downstream.

4. Automated workflow reduces cost

Intelligent bug bounty automation eliminates costly, low value, manual tasks, such as the integration of data from vulnerability reports into organizational workflows. **This automation increases ROI** in three ways. **One**, you don't need to invest so much in skilled security practitioners. **Two**, existing resources can be redeployed to other value-added tasks. **Three**, process automation reduces expensive bureaucracy and 'rubberstamping'.



Bug Bounty enables digital dexterity and continuous deployment at pace

YesWeHack Bug Bounty is disrupting traditional pentesting. **Our platform is purpose-built** to provide digital dexterity and enable continuous deployment at pace and with quantified ROI. Today, more than 400 programs are in operation, spanning 30+ countries. **YesWeHack Bug Bounty** is also number one among the research community: more than 21,000 ethical hackers rely on the platform, in more than 170 countries.

Commenting on the ROI achieved using YesWeHack Bug Bounty, the **eSignature leader YouSign** comments, *"Yousign carries out one pentest each year. And this is quite expensive, compared to a Bug Bounty program. It's a bit crazy when you think about it: they cost more or less the same, but Bug Bounty covers an entire year, whereas an audit only lasts a week."*

To learn how YesWeHack Bug Bounty can help your organization deliver unparalleled vulnerability management at lower cost, contact us for a free 30min consultation.

Why elevate your security with YESWEHACK?

Cyber threats are increasing – together with your needs for agility. As a result, traditional approaches and tools no longer meet the challenges of digital transformation. YesWeHack and its global community of experts provide you with a disruptive solution: Bug Bounty.

YesWeHack's Bug Bounty platform complies with the strictest European standards and regulations to protect its customers and hunters' interests.